



Entertainment Technology

Section Name: H01

Credit Hours: 3.00

Course Hours: 3.00

Mode of Instruction: Hybrid Synchronous

Meeting Details: Thursday 02:30PM-05:00PM OL-01, Thursday 02:30PM-05:00PM V-V-225

GitHub repository: <https://github.com/entertainmenttechnology/Smith-MTEC-4502-2026S>

Course Instructors

David B Smith

Email: dsmith@citytech.cuny.edu

Phone Number: 718-260-4982

Office Hours

Mon 3:00-4:30, Wed 12:00-1:00

Office Location

LG-38

Also I take many appointments ad-hoc: reach out!

Student Hours

Virtual Office:

Zoom link 649-104-8253

Passcode 'Advise'

In-Person:

Office is in LG-38 (Namm complex). Office hours will be either via Zoom or in person.

Course Coordinator

I am the course coordinator

Course Description

Prepares students for the transition from academic life to the professional world. Topics covered include selection and presentation of portfolio items, resume preparation, interviewing skills, budgeting and financial concerns, and how to navigate a first job. For hybrid and online sections, minimum technology requirements are a working camera and microphone. Students are to switch both on at the instructor's request.

Through a series of scaffolded projects—including a reflective career essay, résumé, professional portfolio, cover letter, and budgeting exercise—students develop the tools, strategies, and professional materials necessary for career placement and advancement. The course emphasizes self-evaluation, readiness analysis, and the ability to communicate professional identity across diverse platforms.

Students select a portfolio platform appropriate to their goals and learn to present their work effectively in digital and professional contexts. Throughout the semester, they will engage in cycles of drafting, critique, and revision, gaining feedback from peers and the instructor. Each project is approached as an iterative development process, with emphasis on reflection, planning, production, and assessment.

Collaborative AI is integrated into the workflow, encouraging students to explore how AI can serve as a partner in brainstorming, drafting, design, and revision—while also critically evaluating its limitations and documenting its contributions. In addition, a budgeting module introduces resource management as a core professional skill, expanding the concept beyond money to include time, space, and quality trade-offs.

By the end of the semester, students will have assembled a professional portfolio, articulated a strategic career development plan, and practiced presenting their materials in professional contexts, positioning them to enter the workforce or pursue graduate study with confidence.

Laptop Requirement

All students **must have a laptop suitable for performing classwork**. Laptops are required at all sessions, including in-person classroom sessions. See the Entertainment Technology Department [web page](#) on the City Tech website for recommended specifications.

Required Software

Software:: GitHub, GitHub Desktop

Link:: <https://github.com/apps/desktop>

Notes:: Our GitHub repository s here:

<https://github.com/entertainmenttechnology/Smith-MTEC-4502-2026S>

Software:: Zotero, Zotero Connector, Zotero Desktop

Link:: <https://www.zotero.org/>

Learning Outcomes

General Education Learning Outcomes

For the successful completion of this course, the student should be able to:	Evaluation methods and criteria:
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For the successful completion of this course, the student should be able to:	Evaluation methods and criteria:
Establish personal career goals and articulate a strategic plan for achieving them	Reflective & Analytical Essay (initial draft, strategic framework, visual aids); revisions based on feedback
Prepare a professional portfolio on a platform appropriate to career goals	Selection of portfolio items, platform design, peer and instructor critiques, iterative updates
Prepare a résumé and cover letter tailored to specific job or graduate program opportunities	Drafts and revisions of résumé and cover letter; critique and revision cycles
Present a professional pitch (introducing their work, services, or career identity)	In-class rehearsals and final presentation of a timed professional pitch supported by portfolio materials
Evaluate resource trade-offs and demonstrate how budgeting informs professional decision-making and career development	Budgeting Reflection + Budget Artifact integrated into portfolio; demonstration of budgeting philosophy
Effectively collaborate with AI resources to explore, draft, and refine professional materials in an ethical and transparent way	Documentation of AI use in essays, résumé drafts, portfolio development, and reflections

General Education Learning Outcomes

General Education Learning Outcomes

For the successful completion of this course, the student should be able to:	Evaluation methods and criteria:
Communicate effectively across written, oral, and visual modalities in diverse professional contexts	Personal essay, résumé, portfolio, cover letter, budget artifact, professional pitch, communicated both in person and over remote communication modalities

For the successful completion of this course, the student should be able to:	Evaluation methods and criteria:
Apply critical self-assessment and peer critique to refine professional goals and materials	Revision of assignments after structured feedback from peers, instructor, and AI
Acquire and adapt tools for lifelong learning and professional growth	Research on industry expectations; matching skills to opportunities; creation of strategic framework
Evaluate the role of resource management and decision-making in professional readiness	Budgeting assignment; reflection on trade-offs; integration into portfolio

Grading

Grading

Assignment / Component	Weight
Reflective & Analytical Essay (strategic career planning scaffold)	10%
Résumé & Cover Letter (professional application materials)	10%
Budgeting as Professional Practice	10%
AI Collaboration (documentation of ethical, transparent use across assignments)	10%
Participation (attendance, in-class journals, critiques, discussion)	10%
Online Portfolio (platform of choice, iterative updates, final presentation)	50%
TOTAL	100%

AI Statement

All borrowed text, code, or media used for this course must be attributed to the original creator, whether human or AI. Any direct text quotes from another source must be specified with quotes and appropriately cited. Code borrowed from

another source at more than four lines in length must be attributed as a comment within the code itself. If you are unsure of whether or not your work may constitute plagiarism, please check with your instructor before submitting. Any instance of plagiarism will be reported to the MTEC Program Director, Chair of ENT, and City Tech’s Academic Integrity Officer.

For more information (as well on guidance on how to cite AI), please visit:

[City Tech's AI Guidance](#)

Grading Schema

Letter Grade	Numerical Grade Range
A	93 - 100
A-	90 - 92.9
B+	87 - 89.9
B	83 - 86.9
B-	80 - 82.9
C+	77 - 79.9
C	70 - 76.9
D	60 - 69.9
F	59.9 and below

Course Schedule

Weekly Schedule

Week	Date	Format	Topic / Focus	Assignment / Deliverable

Week	Date	Format	Topic / Focus	Assignment / Deliverable
1	Jan 29	IP	Course Introduction: Career Development & Professional Placement. In-Class: Journal Entry #1 (Speculative Reflection) before lecture.	Begin Reflective Essay Draft (Assignment 1, Part 1)
2	Feb 5	Zoom	Charting a Career Path	Reflective Essay Draft Due (Assignment 1, Part 1)
	Feb 12		NO CLASSES SCHEDULED	
3	Feb 19	IP	Self-Analysis & Career Strategy	Final Reflective Essay + Strategic Framework Draft (Assignment 1, Part 2)
4	Feb 26	Zoom	Matching Skills and Opportunities	Visual Aids Draft (Assignment 1, Part 3)
5	March 5	Zoom	Presenting Frameworks	Final Strategic Framework (Assignment 1 Part 4)
6	March 12	IP	The Résumé	Résumé Draft Due
7	March 19	Zoom	Résumé & Portfolio Item Evaluation	Portfolio item list + platform selection
8	March 26	IP	Portfolio Implementation	Updated résumé + portfolio draft
	April 2		SPRING BREAK	
	April 9		SPRING BREAK	
9	April 16	IP	Portfolio Feedback (Round 1)	Portfolio update
10	April 21 TUESDAY!!!	IP	Portfolio Feedback (Round 2)	—

Week	Date	Format	Topic / Focus	Assignment / Deliverable
11	April 23	Zoom	Cover Letters	Cover Letter Draft Due
12	April 30	IP	Cover Letter Feedback + Workplace Ethics	Updated Cover Letter
13	May 7	Zoom	Budgeting as Professional Practice	Budget Reflection + Artifact added to Portfolio
14	May 14	IP	Portfolio Integration & Professional Pitch	Portfolio Pitch Rehearsal
15	May 21	IP	Final Presentations and Pitch	Final Portfolio (Essay, Résumé, Cover Letter, Budgeting section)

City Tech Email

Use your official city tech e-mail for all correspondence. Check it regularly for class announcements and information. Throughout the semester, you may receive messages about achievements, goals, and requirements in this class. Messages from private email addresses may be ignored.

Camera Policy for Online and Hybrid Courses

For virtual sessions (online), the Department of Entertainment Technology requires all students to have their camera on to receive credit for participation.

Attendance and Participation

A student who is not in a class for any reason is not receiving the benefit of the education being provided. Missed class time includes not just absences but also lateness, early departures, and time outside the classroom taken by students during class meeting periods. Missed time impacts any portion of the final grade overtly allocated to participation and/or any grades awarded for activities that relate to presence in class.

Absence is failure to attend any part of the class, from roll call to dismissal. Please note that sleeping or putting your head down on your desk means that you are not present in the class. The same is applied to unauthorized use of electronic devices, leaving the classroom during class, or leaving early.

Students may sometimes need to miss class for important personal reasons. Please make sure to communicate with your instructor in advance, or as soon as possible, about any of the following events. Illness or a sudden emergency. Religious Observance ([Absences Related to Religious Observance](#)). Bereavement ([Student Bereavement Policy](#))

Participation is expected at every class meeting. Active participation is an essential part of the learning process and is required of all enrolled students. Participation means maintaining an active presence in class in order to take part in discussion and in-class activities. Missed time impacts any portion of the final grade overtly allocated to participation and/or any grades awarded for activities that relate to presence in class.

Academic Integrity

Students and all others who work with information, ideas, texts, images, music, inventions, and other intellectual property owe their audience and sources accuracy and honesty in using, crediting, and citation of sources. As a community of intellectual and professional workers, the college recognizes its responsibility for providing instruction in information literacy and academic integrity, offering models of good practice, and responding vigilantly and appropriately to infractions of academic integrity. Accordingly, academic dishonesty is prohibited in The City University of New York and is punishable by penalties, including failing grades, suspension, and expulsion. The complete text of the College policy on Academic Integrity may be found in the catalog.

For more information, please visit:

[City Tech Academic Integrity website](#)

[CUNY Academic Integrity Policy](#)

Late Work Policy

The materials you create in this course — résumé, portfolio, cover letter, reflective/strategic essay, and budgeting framework — are **professional development documents** that will continue to evolve throughout your career.

Because of this, none are ever "complete", and thus **class assessment is always based on the materials as they exist at the time of the final pitch presentation.**

- **Iterative Development:** Students are expected to revise and refine their materials continuously across the semester. Missing an intermediate deadline means losing valuable critique and feedback opportunities, but the work will still be reviewed in whatever form it exists at the pitch.
- **Assessment Timing:** Final grading will be based on the state of your materials at the final pitch (Week 15). Documents not available at that time cannot be assessed.

- **Implications for Late Work:** “Late” work is accepted in the sense that revisions can be made at any point up until the pitch. However, postponing work reduces feedback opportunities and can weaken the quality of the final presentation.
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ENT Department Commitment to Student Diversity

This course welcomes students from all backgrounds, experiences and perspectives. In accordance with the City Tech and CUNY missions, this course intends to provide an atmosphere of inclusion, respect, and the mutual appreciation of differences so that together we can create an environment in which all students can flourish. It is the instructor's goal to provide materials and activities that are welcoming and accommodating of diversity in all of its forms, including race, gender identity and presentation, ethnicity, national origin, religion, cultural identity, socioeconomic background, sexuality and sexual orientation, ability, neurodivergence, age, and etc. Your instructor is committed to equity and actively seeks ways to challenge institutional racism, sexism, ableism and other forms of prejudice. Your input is encouraged and appreciated. If a dynamic that you observe or experience in the course concerns you, you may respectfully inform your instructor without fear of how your concerns will affect your grade. Let your instructor know how to improve the effectiveness of the course for you personally, or for other students or student groups. We acknowledge that NYCCT is located on the traditional homelands of the Canarsie and Lenape peoples.

Accommodations for Students with Disabilities

[Center for Student Accessibility](#)

City Tech is committed to supporting the educational goals of enrolled students with disabilities. If you have or think you may have a disability, you may be eligible for reasonable accommodations or academic adjustments as provided under applicable federal, state, and/or city laws. You may also request services for temporary conditions or medical issues under certain circumstances. If you have questions about your eligibility and/or would like to seek accommodation services and/or academic adjustments, please contact the Student Accessibility Center.

Student Assistance

Student Success Center

City Tech's [Student Success Center](#) offers a variety of services to help tackle the challenges of college. This includes emergency grants, financial resources, one-on-one coaching, and skills support in time management, test-taking, note-taking, procrastination, and more.

Student Wellness and Counseling Center

The [Counseling Services Center](#) supports the educational, emotional, and career development of City Tech students by providing opportunities for skill development, counseling, and referrals that address obstacles to success.

Student Resource Hub

The [City Tech Student Hub](#) is a central hub for students at New York City College of Technology, offering quick access to essential resources and services. It provides links to academic tools like Brightspace, student email, and the academic calendar, as well as support services including advising, financial aid, and career resources.

Student HelpDesk

- Room: Library Building L-114
- Phone: 718-260-4900
- Email: StudentHelpDesk@citytech.cuny.edu
- [Free Software Download](#) (Microsoft, AutoCAD, Adobe, and others)

Brightspace 24x7 HelpDesk:

- Phone: 1-888-895-2511
- Email: helpdesk@D2L.com
- [Brightspace Basics for Students Course](#)
- [Brightspace Student Handbook](#)
- Download the [Brightspace Pulse App](#) to your smartphone

For more information, please visit the [Student Resource Hub](#).

Library Services

The [City Tech Library](#) offers in-person research help, research guides, and a 24/7 [Ask a Librarian](#) chat service staffed by real humans. And we're [open late](#) on weeknights if you're taking classes in the evening. In the library, you can print for free and [borrow select textbooks and technology](#), including calculators and laptops.

As part of the CUNY system, City Tech students can also use all of the 25 CUNY college libraries and request books from both CUNY and SUNY colleges to borrow. Follow us on the [Library Buzz Blog](#), Instagram [@citytechlibrary](#), and Bluesky [@citytechlibrary.bsky.social](#) for info about how the library can support you!

City Tech Writing Center

Your City Tech Writing Center is available for in-person and online writing support for any writing you might be working on: essays, OpenLab posts, lab reports, resumes, cover letters, creative work, emails, speeches, presentations...not just your English homework! The Writing Center offers 45-minute, one-on-one sessions with tutors. No matter which phase you're at in your process, from initial brainstorm to final draft, the Writing Center is there to support you. Watch this [VIDEO](#), sign up, or reach out through the links below to learn more!

- Location:** Room G-608 ← 6th floor of the General building
- Email:** writingcenter@citytech.cuny.edu ← Send any questions
- Appointment site:** <https://mywco.com/citytech> ← Register here to make an appointment
- Website:** citytechwritingcenter.com ← Visit this site for more info
- IG:** [@citytechwc](#) ← follow

FAQ's

FAQ	
FAQ	
How do I access course materials and assignments in this class?	All course materials and assignments can be accessed through Brightspace.
What do I need to do every week?	
When are weekly assignments due?	
Can I turn in late work?	
Can I use AI?	
How do I turn in Assignments?	Assignments can be turned in via Brightspace. For more information, read the Brightspace Student Handbook .

FAQ	
How am I being evaluated?	The grading rubric is posted on Brightspace.
Where can I get access to all student support services at City Tech?	Please visit the Student Resource Hub .
When does this course meet?	
How many absences are allowed in this class?	

Procastination Station

The **Procrastination Station** is a friendly, research-based hub that helps students understand why they procrastinate and offers simple, practical tools to get moving. Created by City Tech's First-Year Writing Program, it's packed with tips, activities, and resources for both students and faculty.

Ready to stop putting things off? Visit the site today:

<https://www.yourprocrastinationstation.com/>

AI Use Statement

Overview

This policy outlines the acceptable and encouraged use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in **MTEC 4502: Career and Portfolio Seminar**. In this course, AI is recognized as a **collaborative partner** in analysis, reflection, design, evaluation, and iteration—not as a substitute for student authorship, judgment, or understanding.

AI is increasingly embedded in professional creative, technical, and media ecosystems. As students preparing for careers in emerging and evolving fields, it is essential to understand not only *how* to use AI, but *when*, *why*, and *whether* it should be used. This course treats AI fluency as a form of professional literacy.

Students should view this policy as a framework for **ethical, reflective, and intentional collaboration** with AI, aligned with the course's emphasis on iteration, adaptability, and lifelong professional development.

Guiding Principles

Transparency

Students must clearly indicate when and how AI tools have been used in the development, evaluation, or refinement of their work.

Attribution

Any text, analysis, structure, visual material, or organizational support generated or significantly shaped by AI must be attributed, including the tool name and (when relevant) version.

Agency and Responsibility

AI may support thinking, but it does not replace it. Final decisions, interpretations, and accountability always rest with the student.

Understanding Requirement

If you do not understand an AI-generated output, you may not use it. All AI-assisted content must be reviewed, fact-checked, contextualized, and meaningfully integrated.

Ethics and Integrity

Students are responsible for ensuring that AI use complies with academic integrity standards, avoids plagiarism, respects intellectual property, and adheres to ethical norms.

AI as a Collaborative Partner

In MTEC 4502, AI is framed as a **collaborative partner** that may:

- support speculative thinking about careers and futures
- assist in comparative analysis and evaluation
- help organize complex information (tables, matrices, summaries)
- provide alternative perspectives or critiques
- support iteration and refinement of professional materials

AI should not be treated as an authority, nor as an automated content generator whose output is accepted uncritically.

Acceptable Uses of AI in This Course

Students may choose to use AI tools in ways that support—but do not replace—their own thinking and professional judgment. Acceptable uses include:

- Brainstorming and speculative exploration of career paths
- Comparative analysis of portfolio platforms or professional materials
- Organizational support (tables, outlines, checklists, summaries)
- Feedback and critique on clarity, tone, and structure
- Evaluation of portfolio layouts, usability, or accessibility
- SEO and analytics exploration for professional visibility
- Assisting with documentation formatting (Markdown, tables, structure)
- Supporting reflective analysis of process and decision-making

Students may also elect **not** to use AI, with no penalty, provided that they explicitly state this choice and still demonstrate awareness of AI's impact on their field.

Prohibited or Inappropriate Uses

- Submitting AI-generated work that the student does not understand
 - Representing AI-generated content as wholly original without disclosure
 - Using AI to fabricate experiences, credentials, or outcomes
 - Allowing AI to override professional judgment or ethical responsibility
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Required Documentation of AI Use

Whenever AI tools are used, students must include an **AI Use Acknowledgment** that describes:

- The AI tool(s) used (e.g., ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Gemini, design or analytics tools)
- The purpose of AI use (analysis, feedback, organization, speculation, etc.)
- The nature of the contribution (what the AI helped with)

This acknowledgment should appear in a visible location, such as:

- A portfolio page or footer
- A README or reflection document
- A caption or appendix to a report or other product
- A discussion post or presentation slide

Screenshots, links to AI conversations, or summarized prompts may be included when helpful.

Iterative Use and Reflection

AI use in this course is expected to be **iterative**, not one-off. Students should reflect on:

- how AI influenced their thinking
- what insights or limitations emerged
- where human judgment was essential
- how their use of AI evolved over time

This reflection is part of the learning outcome of the course.

Relationship to Student Beliefs and Preferences

The course recognizes that students may hold different perspectives on AI. Respectful accommodation is provided:

- AI use is encouraged but not mandatory
- Non-use must be intentional and documented
- All students must demonstrate AI literacy, regardless of use

Understanding AI's role in professional practice is considered essential preparation for emerging media careers.

Misuse and Violations

Failure to disclose AI use, or misuse of AI in ways that violate academic integrity or ethical standards, may result in work being considered incomplete or subject to review under institutional policies.

TL;DR

AI in MTEC 4502 is a **collaborative partner**, not a shortcut.

You are encouraged to explore it thoughtfully, document its use transparently, and remain fully responsible for your work, decisions, and understanding.

AI Use Acknowledgment (for This Policy)

This policy was developed through an iterative, collaborative process between Dr. David B. Smith and AI systems including ChatGPT and Gemini, and refined through prior course implementations and CHI-aligned pedagogical research. It reflects ongoing evolution in AI-supported professional practice and education.